How to edit and publish this site

A plain-language guide. No coding experience assumed — if you can use Notepad or TextEdit, you can do everything in here.

1. What's in the folder

```
site/
├── index.html          the home page
├── work.html           the portfolio / gallery page
├── contact.html        the contact page
├── GUIDE.md            this file
├── css/
│   └── style.css       all the colours, fonts and layout
├── js/
│   └── main.js         the menu, the fade-ins and the pop-up gallery
└── images/
    ├── work-1.svg … work-6.svg   the six project pictures
    ├── portrait.svg              the "about me" picture
    ├── favicon.svg               the little icon in the browser tab
    ├── apple-touch-icon.png      the same icon for phone home screens
    └── og-card.svg               the preview image used by social media
```

That is the whole site. There is no database, no login, nothing to install.

Before you change anything: make a copy of the whole `site` folder and keep it somewhere safe. If an edit goes wrong you can just put the old file back.

2. How to open the files

- **Windows** — right-click the file → *Open with* → *Notepad*.
- **Mac** — right-click → *Open With* → *TextEdit*. The first time, go to TextEdit → Settings → Format → tick **Plain text**, or it will add invisible formatting that breaks the page.
- **Better option (free)** — install VS Code. It colours the code, which makes it much harder to delete the wrong thing.

To see your change: save the file, then double-click `index.html`. It opens in your browser straight from your computer. Press **Ctrl+R** (Windows) or **Cmd+R** (Mac) to refresh after each save.

3. The one rule

HTML is made of **tags** in angle brackets, in pairs:

```
<h1>I design calm, useful interfaces</h1>
 ↑ opening tag                        ↑ closing tag (note the slash)
```

Change the words between the tags. Leave the tags alone. That's it.

```
<h1>Photography that doesn't waste your afternoon</h1>   ← fine
<h1>Photography that doesn't waste your afternoon        ← broken, no closing tag
```

If you need a real `<`, `>` or `&` in your text, type `<`, `>` or `&` instead.

4. Changing the text

Open the page you want, find the words, type over them. The most common ones:

What you want to change	File	Look for
Name in the top-left corner	all three	`<span class="logo__text">`
The two letters in the green square	all three	`<span class="logo__mark">`
Big headline on the home page	`index.html`	`<h1 class="hero__title">`
Paragraph under the headline	`index.html`	`<p class="hero__lead">`
"A little about me" text	`index.html`	`class="about__text"`
The three numbers (10+, 40, 6)	`index.html`	`class="facts"`
Project names and dates	`work.html`	`class="gallery__title"`
Studio address, hours, links	`contact.html`	`class="details"`
Copyright line at the bottom	all three	`class="site-footer__copy"`

Each section in every file has a comment above it like `<!-- ====== HERO ====== -->` so you can find your way around by scrolling.

5. Changing the pictures

The pictures are currently placeholder artwork I drew so you could see the layout working. Replacing them with your own is two steps.

Step 1 — prepare the file.

- Save as **JPG** for photographs, **PNG** if you need a transparent background.
- Make it **1600 pixels wide at the most**. Anything bigger just makes the page slow; nobody will see the extra detail.
- Run it through squoosh.app (free, no sign-up) and aim for under **200 KB** per picture. This is the single biggest thing you can do to keep the site fast.

Step 2 — put it in place.

Drop the file into the `images` folder, then find the line that points at the old one and change two things: the filename and the description.

```
<img class="gallery__img" src="images/work-1.svg" width="800" height="600" loading="lazy"
decoding="async"
     alt="Northline banking app shown on a phone screen, with a balance card and a list of
transactions.">
```

becomes

```
<img class="gallery__img" src="images/harbour-wedding.jpg" width="1600" height="1200"
loading="lazy" decoding="async"
     alt="Bride and groom on the harbour steps at sunset, confetti in the air.">
```

Three things to get right:

- **`src`** — the filename, spelled exactly, including capital letters. `Photo.JPG` and `photo.jpg` are different files as far as a web server is concerned, even though they look the same on your own computer.
- **`width` and `height`** — the real pixel size of your image. These stop the page from jumping about while the picture loads. Right-click the file → *Properties* / *Get Info* to find the numbers.
- **`alt`** — a short description of what is in the picture. This is what someone using a screen reader hears, what shows if the image fails to load, and what Google reads. Describe the picture, don't list keywords.

On the `work.html` page each picture appears **twice** on the same line block — once in `href="images/…"` (the big version the pop-up shows) and once in `src="images/…"` (the thumbnail). Change both.

To use the same photo for both, just put the same filename in both places.

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6. Changing the colours

Everything is driven by seven colours at the top of `css/style.css`:

```
:root {
  --paper:      #fbfaf7;   /* page background            */
  --surface:    #ffffff;   /* cards, form fields         */
  --ink:        #15181c;   /* body text                  */
  --muted:      #5c6470;   /* secondary text             */
  --accent:     #1f6f5c;   /* links, buttons, highlights */
  --accent-dk:  #164f42;   /* accent, hover state        */
  --line:       #e4e0d8;   /* hairline borders           */
}
```

Change `--accent` and the buttons, links, logo square and hover underlines all follow. You don't need to hunt through the file.

One warning: light grey text on a white background is pretty but a lot of people genuinely cannot read it. Paste your new colours into webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker and keep the score above **4.5** for body text. The colours shipped here score between 5.7 and 17, so there is plenty of room to make them your own.

There is a second block further down beginning `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)`. That's the dark version the site shows to people whose phone or laptop is set to dark mode. If you only ever want the light version, delete that whole block.

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7. Changing the browser-tab icon (favicon)

Open `images/favicon.svg` in a text editor. It's two lines:

```
<rect width="64" height="64" rx="14" fill="#1f6f5c"/>
<text ...>JA</text>
```

Change `JA` to your own initials and `#1f6f5c` to your colour. Save.

If you'd rather use a logo image, put a 512×512 PNG in the `images` folder and change this line (it's near the top of all three HTML files):

```
<link rel="icon" href="images/favicon.svg" type="image/svg+xml">
```

to

```
<link rel="icon" href="images/my-logo.png" type="image/png">
```

Browsers cache the old icon hard. If you don't see the change, open the page in a private window.

8. Making the contact form actually send you mail

Right now the form checks what the visitor typed and then says thank you — but nothing is sent anywhere. A plain HTML file can't send email on its own; it needs something to hand the message to. The simplest free option:

1. Go to formspree.io, sign up, create a form. It gives you a web address like `https://formspree.io/f/abcdwxyz`.
2. In `contact.html`, find this line:

```html

``` and put the address in the quotes: ```html ``` 3. In `js/main.js`, scroll to the bottom of section 4 and delete these three lines (they are marked with a comment telling you to): ```js e.preventDefault(); status.textContent = 'Thanks — your message looks good. (Demo form: no address is wired up yet.)'; form.reset(); ``` Send yourself a test message and check your spam folder — the first one usually lands there. --- ## 9. Putting the site online Everything here is plain files, so any host will serve it. Three routes, easiest first. ### Option A — Netlify Drop (two minutes, free) 1. Go to [app.netlify.com/drop](https://app.netlify.com/drop). 2. Drag the whole `site` folder onto the page. 3. It's live, on an address like `curious-otter-1a2b3c.netlify.app`. Sign up for the free account afterwards if you want to keep the address or point your own domain at it. To update later, drag the folder on again. ### Option B — your own hosting, via FTP If you bought hosting (Bluehost, SiteGround, Hostinger, a cPanel account…), they gave you FTP details: a server address, a username and a password. 1. Install [FileZilla](https://filezilla-project.org/) (free). 2. Connect with those details. 3. On the right-hand side, open the folder called `public_html`, `www` or `htdocs` — different hosts name it differently; it's the one that's already there. 4. Drag the **contents** of your `site` folder into it: `index.html`, `work.html`, `contact.html`, and the `css`, `js` and `images` folders. Upload the contents, not the `site` folder itself — otherwise your site ends up at `yourdomain.com/site/` instead of `yourdomain.com/`. `index.html` is special: it's the page a web server shows when someone types your domain with nothing after it. Don't rename it. ### Option C — GitHub Pages (free, good if you'll make regular edits) Create a repository, upload the files, then Settings → Pages → Source: *Deploy from a branch* → `main` / `root`. It publishes at `yourname.github.io/repository-name`. Note that the repository must be **public** for Pages to work on a free account. --- ## 10. Before you tell anyone the address A short list worth running through: - [ ] Every page's `